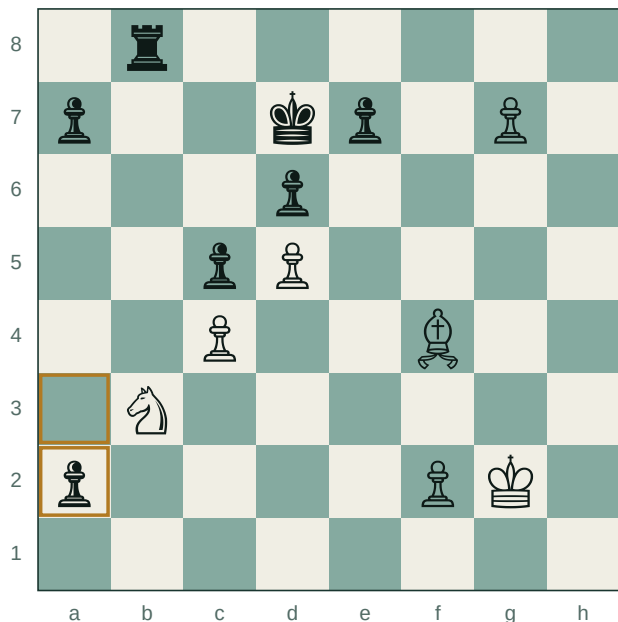


# Promotion combinations: White, move 42

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 41...a2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**42. Nxc5+ dxc5 43. Bxb8 a1=Q 44. g8=Q**

**42.Nxc5+** Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on c5. Recorded reply: **42...dxc5**.

**43.Bxb8** The bishop captures the rook on b8. Recorded reply: **43...a1=Q**.

**44.g8=Q** The pawn moves from g7 to g8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on d7. Geometrically undefended: rook on b8. Check for tactical protection.